

Chris Tham

Strategy Consultant | Technology Strategy, Architecture and Business Change

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PROFILE

Founder of Hello Tham, a boutique strategy consulting company. Available for short to medium term consulting engagements spanning strategic business change, business and operating model design, business process improvement, and technology strategy, architecture and solutions.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Flexible strategic change agent and thought leader** — Led IT strategies and operating models for TransportNSW, Transfield Services, ING, NAB and MLC.
- **Successful and proven technology strategy and architecture leader** — Head of Architecture roles at NAB and MLC; consultant for HP and AT&T/NCR.
- **Recognised technology innovator and industry expert** — Pioneered AI/ML dashboards, omni-channel self-service chatbots and service-oriented architectures.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Learning Facilitator

2024 – Present

Torrens University Australia

- Lecturer in Information Systems in the School of Business, teaching undergraduate and masters students.
- Awarded the Learning and Teaching Merit Award twice, with perfect student satisfaction scores in end-of-trimester student evaluation surveys.

Undergraduate subjects

- **MIS100 Foundations of Information Systems** — how organisations use information systems strategically to solve problems, make decisions and stay competitive, spanning hardware, software, data and emerging technologies, alongside artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, privacy and professional ethics.
- **MIS300 Systems Analysis and Design** — the techniques a systems analyst uses to design information systems that advance organisational goals: analysing and defining requirements, modelling process and data, and transforming user requirements into system design using UML, with an emphasis on user centricity.
- **IND201A Industry Engagement Project** — a work-integrated consultancy project run with external clients through the university's Social Enterprise Hub, building employability skills and team contribution to social and business outcomes, and carrying 100 hours of credit towards industry practicum requirements.

Postgraduate subjects

- **MIS610 Advanced Professional Practice** — industry-led preparation for careers in information systems: professional roles and ethics in a global context, culture, governance, and legal and compliance obligations including GDPR, alongside aligning strategy and change management to business priorities and communicating with technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- **MIS611 Information Systems Capstone** — a work-integrated capstone in which student teams deliver a prototype solution for a client organisation, working through the Stanford design thinking cycle from discovery and empathy mapping to ideation, prototyping and testing, and communicating progress and outcomes to stakeholders and non-specialists.

Principal Consultant and Director

2016 – Present

Hello Tham

- Provided strategic consulting services to TransportNSW and Broadspectrum.

Principal Consultant (Consulting)

2016 – 2019

Transport for NSW

- Provided strategic consulting services:

- Developed a financial model and engaged Finance stakeholders for a business case for a multi-year investment program for a suite of Enterprise applications.
- Led and developed a Proof of Concept of a native iOS app written in Swift authenticating via Azure AD and accessing Outlook calendar and AD details via Microsoft Graph API.
- Led and developed a Proof of Concept demonstrating a Javascript web front end embedded in a ServiceNow portal accessing a backend OData SAP service.
- Facilitated and led a vendor-sponsored Proof of Concept to develop a Chatbot servicing leave requests.
- Developed a set of management KPI dashboards using Tableau and Custom SQL.
- Conducted text analysis machine learning (using fast.ai and AWS SageMaker) to predict correct resolver group for IT incidents.
- Mentored senior employees and participated in Women in IT Leadership group.

Strategy Consultant / Executive Manager (Consulting)

2011 – 2016

Broadspectrum

Strategy Consultant · 2015–2016

- Facilitated and co-developed IT Strategy, including development of roadmap and input into Board paper. Led strategic themes:
- **"Flexible Edges"**: Plug-in sector/service specific solutions to complement core systems.
- **"Analytics"**: Increased use of data to drive performance using Tableau, AWS Redshift based "Big Data" analytics platform, and IoT sensor monitoring.

Executive Manager, Architecture and Design · 2014–2015

- As interim leader, successfully achieved objectives:
- Reviewed roles, responsibilities and skill-sets of the Executive Manager position.
- Defined the role of the SAP strategy and technical relationship management.
- Assisted in the recruitment of the permanent Executive Manager.
- Identified and executed high priority strategic architecture initiatives for FY2015-18.

Strategy Consultant · 2011–2014

- Facilitated evaluation of field service management mobility solutions.
- Analysis of implementation options for a support/shared services operating model.
- Established a data analytics capability in operations and business development.
- Development of a strategic technology architecture and migration roadmap.

Consultant (Consulting)

2011

Thorogood & Associates

- Developed material for a social media workshop.
- Consulted on the business case for an online campus and Western Sydney campus for the University of New England.

Head of Strategy and Architecture

2008

ING Australia

- Successfully established IT Strategy and Architecture Function (team size: approximately 20).
- Key functions included technology strategy and innovation facilitation, enterprise architecture, solution architecture and solution design/estimation.
- Defined the technology strategy and architecture governance model for ING Australia.
- Delivered technology roadmaps for key ING business units including Life Risk, Group Risk, and Direct Insurances.

Head of Architecture / Strategy Consultant

2005 – 2007

NAB Group

Strategy Consultant · 2007

- Provided key input to development of Integrated Platform strategy for NAB Australian region to consolidate technology and vendor diversity.
- Developed strategy and architecture for the NAB Corporate Centre functions (Group Finance, Risk, Treasury, Audit, Secretariat).
- Part of a business strategy team that developed an Australian region business process model.

Head of Architecture, Retail Banking · 2006

- Reinvigorated an architecture team through personal coaching, targeted team building, and external hire (doubled team size).
- Implemented a new team operating model via a consultative approach.
- Delivered target architectures for document production, imaging/workflow, and electronic forms.

Head of Architecture, Distribution · 2005

- Created a new architecture function within a new business unit encompassing all distribution channels (retail, private, business, brokered, financial advisers).
- Team delivered a Sales, Servicing, and Channels business architecture.
- Seconded as team lead for the architecture stream of the 2005 Technology Strategy for the Australian region.

Head of Strategy and Architecture

1998 – 2004

MLC

- Established the architecture function at MLC, re-establishing strategic control over technology from a fully outsourced IT operation.
- Oversaw the introduction of various strategic applications: AdviserCentral, Compass, Masterkey, Siebel.
- Established architecture governance processes now used throughout NAB.
- Established the solution architecture role at MLC (later introduced as a standard role within NAB).
- Led the definition of MLC's IT Strategy in 1999 and the application architecture stream in 2001.
- Part of the team defining MLC's Enterprise Medium Term Vision and business case for the \$200m Amazon Programme.

Architecture Consultant

1995 – 1998

Hewlett Packard

- Consulted to various organisations including Boral on:
- Technology infrastructure strategy.
- Server upgrade business case.
- Data centre consolidation business case.

Architecture Consultant

1992 – 1995

AT&T Global Information Solutions (NCR)

- Consulted to various organisations, including St. George Bank, Franklins, Rockmans, and Telstra.

Treasury Analyst

1990 – 1992

State Bank Victoria

- Systems analysis and software development.
- Financial instruments pricing and risk analysis.

Systems Analyst

1988 – 1990

Optech International

- Systems analysis and software development.
- Financial instruments pricing and risk analysis.

Casual Staff

Bain & Company

- System administration and software development.

Tutor

University of Sydney

- Casual tutor in Basser Department of Computer Science.

1986 – 1988

1987

EDUCATION

Master of Applied Finance

Macquarie University

- Awarded:
- Australian Institute of Bankers Prize for Management of Financial Institutions
- Australian Institute of Bankers "The Institute Prize" (for graduating top of class)

Graduate Diploma

Securities Institute of Australia

- Graduate Diploma in Applied Finance and Investment.

1994

1992

Bachelor of Science (1st Class Honours and University Medal)

University of Sydney

- Awarded:
- E. Trenchard Miller Memorial Scholarship
- University Postgraduate Research Award upon graduation

1983 – 1988

CORE COMPETENCIES

Autonomy	●●●●●○	Problem-solving	●●●●●○
Complexity	●●●●●○	Adaptability	●●●●●○
Creativity	●●●●●○	Communication	●●●●●○
Improvement mindset	●●●●●○	Decision-making	●●●●●○
Influence	●●●●●○	Digital mindset	●●●●●○
Learning and development	●●●●●○	Knowledge	●●●●●○